ChE 20000: Chemical Engineering Seminar
Syllabus – Spring 2026

Course Information

- **CHE 20000:** Chemical Engineering Seminar
- **CRN:** 39589
- **Meeting Day(s) and Time:**
  - Wednesday 3:30pm- 4:20pm
- **Location:** FRNY G124
- **Modality:** Face- to- Face
- **Credit Hours:** 1.0

Instructor Contact Information

Instructor:	Karissa Raderstorf
Office Location:	FRNY G041D
Office Phone:	(765) 494-0756
Purdue Email:	kraderstorf@purdue.edu

Office hours:
In-Person Appointments can be scheduled via email or students may drop-in during Karissa's in-person office hours.

Course Description

An orientation course to inform students of the various areas in chemical engineering, to assist them in selection of electives suited to their particular abilities and interest, and to instill a sense of professional ethics and responsibility.

This course will focus on four main areas/sections:

1. Introduction to the Davidson School of Chemical Engineering
2. Introduction to the Chemical Engineering Curriculum
3. Introduction to the Chemical Engineering Resources and Development
4. Introduction to Career Preparation

How to Succeed in this Course

The following are some strategies and tips to successfully complete this course:

- Read this syllabus carefully so you understand what is expected throughout the semester.
- Be willing and able to commit to attending seminars in-person.
- Be willing to speak up if problems arise. Reaching out for assistance is a critical life skill.
- Accept critical thinking and decision-making as part of the learning process.
- Take advantage of resources discussed in seminar and those listed in our course Brightspace and on your Brightspace homepage as resources for Technology, Academic, Campus, and Health and Well-Being.

Learning Resources, Technology & Texts

- All course materials will be accessible via Bright Space.
- **iClicker Cloud** is used to engage the class in different ways and to record participation and engagement.
  NOTE: Students have already been enrolled in the CHE 200 iClicker course and no additional action is needed.

Learning Outcomes

The goal of this course is to acclimate all new students to the Davidson School of Chemical Engineering introducing the school's faculty, curriculum, policies and procedures. This course also will help educate students about the available resources (academic, personal and professional) within the school and/or on the Purdue campus in addition to providing other tips and tools for succeeding in Chemical Engineering.

Assignments

Your achievement of course learning outcomes will be assessed through a combination of participation & engagement via iClicker in seminar, and an assignment at the conclusion of each course area/section. Details regarding each assignment will be discussed in class and posted on Bright Space.

Assessments	Points
Participation and Engagement	40
Davidson School of ChE Assignment	40
ChE Curriculum Assignment	40
ChE Resources and Development Assignment	40
Career Preparation Assignment	40
	200

Grading Scale

Grades will reflect your achievement of learning outcomes throughout the semester. You will accumulate points as described in the assignments portion above. Final grades will be calculated by adding the total points earned and translating those numbers (out of 200) into the following letters (there will be no partial points or rounding).

NOTE: Students who accumulate 4 unexcused absences will result in repeating the class.

A+: 193 - 200
A: 188 - 192
A-: 180 - 187
B+: 173 - 179
B: 168 - 172
B-: 160 - 167
C+: 153 - 159
C: 147 - 152

C-: 140 - 146
D+: 133- 139
D: 127 - 132
D-: 120 - 126
F: 119 or below

Grades and Grade Reports

This course follows the Grades and Grade reports section of Purdue's Academic Regulations, which states, "**Each student shall be responsible for the completion of all required work**, in each course for which the student has enrolled, by the time of the last scheduled meeting of the class, unless the assignment to the course has been properly withdrawn." **As your instructor, it is my responsibility** to record a grade that indicates your achievement of the course objectives at the close of the semester during which you are enrolled in the course. The course grading scale outlines how those grades will configured.

The University recognizes that there are times when unavoidable absences or other causes beyond a student's control may mean other types of grades must be recorded based on several criteria. A grade of incomplete is just one example. Criteria and associated procedures for incomplete work and other types of grades are spelled out in the Academic Regulations, and it is my responsibility to follow them. If you find yourself in such circumstances, please discuss them with me as early as possible so we can review your options.

Attendance Policy

This course follows the University Academic Regulations regarding class attendance, which state that students are expected to be present for every meeting of the classes in which they are enrolled. Attendance will be taken during class, at random times.

If you are not able to complete the attendance question for any reason during class, please let Karissa know immediately after class or you will be counted absence.

When conflicts or absences can be anticipated, such as for many University-sponsored activities and religious observations, you should inform me of the situation as far in advance as possible. For unanticipated or emergency absences when advance notification to is not possible, contact me as soon as possible by email or phone. For absences that do not fall under excused absence regulations (see below), this course follows the following procedures:

1. Do not come to class if you are feeling ill, but DO email me at kraderstorf@purdue.edu, with the subject line: CHE 20000 Absence. I do not need details about your symptoms. Just let me know you are feeling ill and cannot come to class. If it is an emergency situation, please follow the University regulations on emergent medical care (see below).
2. Unless it falls under the University excused absence regulations (see below), any work due should be submitted on time via our course Brightspace.
3. If that day's class involves assessed work such as a test or presentation, you and I will plan if and how you can make up the work, following the assignment guidelines. This plan must be done before the next class period, so again, email me immediately when you know that you will miss class.

4. The most important consideration in any absence is how it will affect your achievement of the assignment objectives and the course learning outcomes.

For cases that fall under **excused absence regulations**, you or your representative should contact or go to the Office of the Dean of Students (ODOS) website to complete appropriate forms for instructor notification. Under academic regulations, excused absences may be granted by ODOS for cases of grief/bereavement, military service, jury duty, parenting leave, or certain types of medical care. The processes are detailed, so plan ahead.

Should you miss a seminar, for any reason, it is expected you review the recording of the missed seminar once available via Bright Space prior to the next class period.

All unexcused absences, along with excused absences that are not made up for, do count for your attendance points for this course.

NOTE: Students who accumulate 4 unexcused absences will result in repeating the class.

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information is submitted the greater the opportunity for the university to investigate the concern. More details are available on our course Brightspace under University Policies.

Nondiscrimination Statement

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community that recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. The University believes that diversity among its many members strengthens the institution, stimulates creativity, promotes the exchange of ideas, and enriches campus life. A hyperlink to Purdue's full Nondiscrimination Policy Statement is included in our course Brightspace under University Policies and Statements.

Accessibility

Every member of our course should be able to access, use, and learn from the materials we share. This includes all course-related digital content that you and I share in the course. This approach helps promote equal access for everyone at Purdue and is mandated federally by Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). We will work together to provide this access within our Brightspace course.

- My part, as instructor, is to make sure all course materials shared to Brightspace, such as documents, slides, videos and audio, and images, meet accessibility guidelines and to assist you in making sure anything you share is accessible.
- Your role, as a student, is to make sure anything you post for other students to engage with is also accessible, such as peer grading, peer feedback, and discussion board posts.

This expectation is built into all course assignments that require you to post to Brightspace.

- A good starting place for you is to bookmark and review the Innovative Learning Accessibility Checklist for guidance on creating accessible materials.
- When selecting materials to share on our Brightspace from Purdue Libraries catalog or databases, best practices include choosing items that:
  - Can be downloaded in full
  - Are available in EPUB or HTML formats
  - Include alternative text for written materials or captions for audio/visual content

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247, as soon as possible.

Mental Health/Wellness Statement

If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try Therapy Assistance Online (TAO), a web and app-based mental health resource available courtesy of Purdue Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS). TAO is available to all students at any time by creating an account on the TAO Connect website, or downloading the app from the App Store or Google Play. It offers free, confidential well-being resources through a self-guided program informed by psychotherapy research and strategies that may aid in overcoming anxiety, depression and other concerns. It provides accessible and effective resources including short videos, brief exercises, and self-reflection tools.

If you need support and information about options and resources, please contact or see the Office of the Dean of Students. Call 765-494-1747. Hours of operation are M-F, 8 a.m.- 5 p.m.

If you find yourself struggling to find a healthy balance between academics, social life, stress, etc., sign up for free one-on-one virtual or in-person sessions in West Lafayette with a Purdue Wellness Coach at RecWell. Student coaches can help you navigate through barriers and challenges toward your goals throughout the semester. Sign up is free and can be done on BoilerConnect. Students in Indianapolis will find support services curated on the Vice Provost for Student Life website.

If you're struggling and need mental health services: Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS offices in West Lafayette or Indianapolis.

Emergency Preparation

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or

other circumstances beyond the instructor's control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the instructors or TAs via email or phone. You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.

See Purdue's Information on Emergency Preparation and Planning. This website covers topics such as Severe Weather Guidance, Emergency Plans, and a place to sign up for the Emergency Warning Notification System. I encourage you to download and review the *Emergency Preparedness for Classrooms document*.

The first day of class, I will review the **Emergency Preparedness plan for our specific classroom**. Please make note of items like:

- The location to where we will proceed after evacuating the building if we hear a fire alarm.
- The location of our Shelter in Place in the event of a tornado warning.
- The location of our Shelter in Place in the event of an active threat such as a shooting.

Student Related Policies

The Vice President for Ethics & Compliance website includes a list of Student Policies. Among those is the Violent Behavior policy, which explains that Purdue is committed to providing a safe and secure campus environment for members of the university community. Purdue strives to create an educational environment for students and a work environment for employees that promote educational and career goals. Violent behavior impedes such goals. Therefore, violent behavior is prohibited in or on any University facility or while participating in any university activity.

Basic Needs Security

If you are facing challenges securing basic needs such as food, housing, transportation, health services, or access to technology or childcare resources and believe this may affect your performance in the course, please contact the Office of the Dean of Students (ODOS) to help coordinate with community resources. These services vary by location. In **West Lafayette**, see the Basic Needs Program website, or email basicneeds@purdue.edu.

Course Evaluation

Toward the end of this semester, you will be provided with an opportunity to give feedback on this course and your instructor. Purdue uses an online course evaluation system, and I will not have access to this anonymous feedback until after final grades are submitted. You will receive an official email from evaluation administrators with a link to the online evaluation site and will receive a prompt to complete the survey when you login to Brightspace. The subject line will be: *Please take 2-5 minutes to complete the survey*. Check your "Junk E-mail" folder occasionally to be sure the evaluation emails were not accidentally routed there. Your participation is an integral part of this course, and your feedback is vital to improving education at Purdue University. I strongly urge you to participate in the evaluation system.

NOTE: This syllabus is subject to change. You will be notified of any changes as far in advance as possible via an announcement on Brightspace. Monitor your Purdue email daily for updates.